

D577

Team Dynamics

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A six-person quality-improvement team at a clinic, formed in March and funded by a state grant, has now met four times. Members have begun arguing about who should run meetings and are challenging the project's scope. Which stage of team development is the team in?

- A. Forming.
- B. The team is failing and should be disbanded.
- C. Storming.
- D. Norming.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team has agreed on meeting rules, accepted each member's role, and now gives open feedback, though its output is still ramping up. Which stage should come next?

- A. Performing.
- B. Storming.
- C. Forming.
- D. Adjourning.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

Two department heads at a manufacturing company, both known for long tenures, disagree about where to cut the budget. The outcome matters a great deal to each of them, and they have two weeks before the plan is due. Which conflict-handling mode fits best?

- A. Competing.
- B. Avoiding.
- C. Compromising.
- D. Collaborating.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A supervisor gives in to a colleague's preferred schedule on an issue that matters little to her but a great deal to him, to protect their working relationship. Which conflict-handling mode is she using?

- A.** Accommodating.
- B.** Collaborating.
- C.** Avoiding.
- D.** Compromising.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A product design team, meeting on a new video platform, is sharply debating which of two prototypes to launch. Each side is citing user-test data, and the meeting runs long. What should the team leader do?

- A.** Switch video platforms so meetings run shorter.
- B.** End all disagreement at once to protect team harmony.
- C.** Let the debate continue while keeping it focused on the evidence and the options.
- D.** Treat it as a personality clash and move members to separate projects.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A coworker from the billing office, which just switched software vendors, says, 'I'm tired of getting blamed for claim denials that start at the front desk.' Which response best shows active listening?

- A.** 'Here is what you should do: send the front desk a list of errors.'
- B.** 'Don't take it personally; everyone gets blamed sometimes.'
- C.** 'The new software is probably causing the denials.'
- D.** 'It sounds like you feel blamed for problems that start before claims reach you. Is that right?'

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

On a hospital unit that recently earned a national quality award, a new nurse saw a near miss but did not report it, because the charge nurse had publicly criticized a colleague for an earlier error. Which action best builds psychological safety?

- A. Discipline anyone who fails to report a near miss.
- B. Run one anonymous survey a year and change nothing else.
- C. Leaders openly invite reports, thank people for speaking up, and review errors without blame.
- D. Celebrate the unit's quality award at the next staff meeting.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A close-knit executive team that has worked together for ten years, and just posted a record year, agreed within minutes to buy a competitor. The CEO stated her preference at the start, and no one raised a concern. Which safeguard would best reduce the risk of a poor decision?

- A. Require unanimous agreement before any decision.
- B. Decide even faster to build on the record year.
- C. Add new members who share the team's views.
- D. Assign a devil's advocate and have the CEO hold her view until others speak.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which observation is a symptom of groupthink?

- A. Members keep their doubts to themselves because they assume everyone else agrees.
- B. Members argue over roles in the first few meetings.
- C. The team asks outside experts to critique its plan.
- D. Members debate openly before settling on a choice.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A project coordinator at a county health department, which serves 90,000 residents, briefs her director with SBAR about a delay in equipment for a new clinic. Which statement belongs in the Recommendation?

- A. 'I think the delay puts our opening date at risk.'
- B. 'I suggest we approve the backup vendor today so the clinic opens on schedule.'
- C. 'The vendor told us this morning the equipment will be three weeks late.'
- D. 'We signed the contract in May after a competitive bid.'

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In an SBAR briefing, where does this statement belong: 'I believe the opening date is at risk because the room cannot be certified without the equipment'?

- A. Background.
- B. Assessment.
- C. Recommendation.
- D. Situation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

12.

Two nurse managers at a hospital where the cafeteria was recently remodeled both demand the same conference room every Tuesday at 10 a.m. One needs privacy for confidential staff reviews; the other needs a large screen for training. What is the best way to resolve the dispute?

- A. Flip a coin to decide who gets the room.
- B. Explore each manager's underlying need and build options that meet both, such as a private office for reviews and the room for training.
- C. Give the room to the more senior manager.
- D. Alternate weeks so each gets the room half the time.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A six-person quality-improvement team at a clinic, ~~formed in March and funded by a state grant~~, has now met four times. Members have begun arguing about who should run meetings and are challenging the project's scope. Which stage of team development is the team in?

Target word: current stage **Decides:** Open conflict over roles and scope after the first meetings.

A	Adjacent category	Forming is the polite, uncertain start before conflict appears.
B	Absolute language	Storming is a normal stage, not proof of failure.
C	Correct	Conflict over leadership, roles, and direction marks storming.
D	Confusion set	Norming comes after conflict is resolved and shared rules are accepted.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

A team has agreed on meeting rules, accepted each member's role, and now gives open feedback, though its output is still ramping up. Which stage should come next?

Target word: next stage after norming **Decides:** Shared norms are set; the team is in norming.

A	Correct	After norms are set, teams move into high, self-directed productivity.
B	Inverted operation	Moves the team backward; storming precedes norming.
C	Confusion set	Forming is the starting stage.
D	Dropped element	Skips performing; adjourning happens when the work ends.

3. Answer D Concept 2

Two department heads at a manufacturing company, ~~both known for long tenures~~, disagree about where to cut the budget. The outcome matters a great deal to each of them, and they have two weeks before the plan is due. Which conflict-handling mode fits best?

Target word: best mode **Decides:** High stakes for both sides and time to work it through.

A	Confusion set	Fits emergencies or unpopular must-do actions, not a shared budget decision with time.
B	Inverted operation	Low on both assertiveness and cooperation, the opposite of what high stakes call for.
C	Adjacent category	Splits the difference; each gets only part of what matters when a fuller solution is possible.
D	Correct	Both sides' concerns matter and time allows a solution that meets both.

4. Answer A Concept 2 • transfer

A supervisor gives in to a colleague's preferred schedule on an issue that matters little to her but a great deal to him, to protect their working relationship. Which conflict-handling mode is she using?

Target word: name the mode **Decides:** Low assertiveness, high cooperativeness.

A	Correct	Yielding one's own concern to satisfy the other's is accommodating.
B	Inverted operation	Collaborating is high assertiveness; she set her own concern aside.
C	Dropped element	Avoiding is low on cooperation too; she actively helped the other side.
D	Adjacent category	Compromise means both give up something; she gave in fully.

5. Answer C Concept 3

A product design team, ~~meeting on a new video platform~~, is sharply debating which of two prototypes to launch. Each side is citing user-test data, ~~and the meeting runs long~~. What should the team leader do?

Target word: leader's response to the debate **Decides:** The conflict is about ideas and evidence, not people.

A	Camouflage	Responds to the meeting logistics, which do not decide how to handle the conflict.
B	Absolute language	Suppressing task conflict loses the benefit of debate.
C	Correct	Moderate task conflict improves decisions when kept on ideas.
D	Confusion set	Mistakes task conflict for relationship conflict.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A coworker from the billing office, ~~which just switched software vendors~~, says, 'I'm tired of getting blamed for claim denials that start at the front desk.' Which response best shows active listening?

Target word: best listening response **Decides:** Reflect meaning and feeling and check understanding first.

A	Dropped element	Skips understanding and jumps to advice.
B	Adjacent category	Reassurance that dismisses the feeling instead of reflecting it.
C	Camouflage	Seizes on the vendor change and shifts the topic.
D	Correct	Paraphrases content and feeling, then checks understanding.

7. Answer C Concept 5

On a hospital unit ~~that recently earned a national quality award~~, a new nurse saw a near miss but did not report it, because the charge nurse had publicly criticized a colleague for an earlier error. Which action best builds psychological safety?

Target word: best action to encourage speaking up **Decides:** Fear of blame caused the silence.

A	Inverted operation	Adds more fear, the cause of the silence.
B	Dropped element	Leaves the leader behavior that caused fear in place.
C	Correct	Removes the fear that silenced the nurse.
D	Camouflage	The award does not decide whether staff feel safe to speak up.

8. Answer D Concept 6

A close-knit executive team that has worked together for ten years, ~~and just posted a record year~~, agreed within minutes to buy a competitor. The CEO stated her preference at the start, and no one raised a concern. Which safeguard would best reduce the risk of a poor decision?

Target word: groupthink safeguard **Decides:** High cohesion, leader spoke first, no dissent.

A	Confusion set	Pressure for unanimity is a driver of groupthink, not a cure.
B	Camouflage	Uses the record year, which does not make the choice sound.
C	Inverted operation	Increases sameness, feeding groupthink.
D	Correct	Both counter the pressure toward premature agreement.

9. Answer A Concept 6 · transfer

Which observation is a symptom of groupthink?

Target word: identify a symptom **Decides:** Self-censorship and an illusion of agreement.

A	Correct	Self-censorship and the illusion of unanimity are classic symptoms.
B	Adjacent category	That describes the storming stage.
C	Confusion set	Outside critique is a remedy, not a symptom.
D	Inverted operation	Open debate is the opposite of groupthink.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A project coordinator at a county health department, ~~which serves 90,000 residents,~~ briefs her director with SBAR about a delay in equipment for a new clinic. Which statement belongs in the Recommendation?

Target word: the Recommendation line **Decides:** Recommendation states the action being requested.

A	Dropped element	An interpretation is the Assessment; it stops short of asking for action.
B	Correct	A specific requested action is the Recommendation.
C	Confusion set	What is happening now is the Situation.
D	Adjacent category	Context is Background.

11. Answer B Concept 7 · transfer

In an SBAR briefing, where does this statement belong: 'I believe the opening date is at risk because the room cannot be certified without the equipment'?

Target word: classify the statement **Decides:** It is the speaker's interpretation of the problem.

A	Inverted operation	Background looks back at history; this looks forward to consequences.
B	Correct	The speaker's judgment of what the facts mean is the Assessment.
C	Adjacent category	No action is requested.
D	Confusion set	Situation is the plain statement of what is happening.

12. Answer B Concept 8

Two nurse managers at a hospital ~~where the cafeteria was recently remodeled~~ both demand the same conference room every Tuesday at 10 a.m. One needs privacy for confidential staff reviews; the other needs a large screen for training. What is the best way to resolve the dispute?

Target word: best resolution approach **Decides:** Different underlying needs behind the same demand.

A	Adjacent category	A fair procedure, but it ignores the needs and leaves one side unmet.
B	Correct	Focusing on interests can satisfy both needs.
C	Confusion set	Uses rank, not interests, and breeds resentment.
D	Dropped element	Splits the positions without looking at the needs that could both be met.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	2	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	9	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Stages of team development	Teams typically move through forming, storming, norming, performing, and adjourning; conflict over roles and direction marks storming.	Reading early conflict as proof the team is failing.	Arguments over who leads or what the scope is, after a polite start.
2	Conflict-handling modes	Collaborating is high assertiveness and high cooperation and fits important issues with time to work through; accommodating yields, avoiding withdraws, competing pushes, compromising splits the difference.	Treating compromise as the best answer to every conflict.	How much the issue matters to each side and how much time there is.
3	Task vs. relationship conflict	Moderate task conflict about ideas and evidence can improve decisions; relationship conflict about personalities harms teams.	Shutting down every disagreement to keep harmony.	A debate over options or data vs. personal attacks.
4	Active listening	Reflect or paraphrase the speaker's meaning and feeling, and check understanding before advising or explaining.	Jumping to reassurance, advice, or a fix.	"Best response" to an upset colleague.
5	Psychological safety	Members speak up about errors and concerns when leaders invite input and respond without blame.	Using punishment or pressure to force reporting.	Someone stayed silent after seeing a peer criticized.
6	Groupthink	Cohesive groups under a directive leader tend to suppress doubts; assign a devil's advocate and have the leader speak last.	Reading quick unanimous agreement as a sign of a strong team.	Fast agreement, a leader's early opinion, and no raised concerns.
7	SBAR structured communication	Situation (what is happening now), Background (relevant context), Assessment (what you think it means), Recommendation (what you want done).	Mixing up assessment and recommendation, or opening with long background.	A statement to classify within a briefing.
8	Interests vs. positions	Resolve disputes by uncovering the needs behind each side's demand and building options that meet both.	Bargaining over the stated demands or deferring to rank.	Two parties demanding the same thing for different reasons.

Course scope (public description): Team Dynamics explores interpersonal communication strategies, collaborative team interactions methods, and problem-solving techniques to promote effective communication and improve quality outcomes in a professional environment. In this course, students will apply psychologically-sound approaches for resolving conflicts, allowing them to navigate challenging workplace disagreements and personalities. Students in this course will apply their skills to various situations. There are no prerequisites for this course.